

MANUALLY OPERATED REPEATING RIFLES (1880–88)

By the end of the 1870s, military authorities in most of Europe and North America had realized the benefits of effective repeating rifles—those that fired multiple rounds from a magazine. Most of them had also recognized that the bolt-action breech mechanism (see p.114) offered the best design for military use, although lever-action rifles continued to be employed. Bolt-action designs were very robust, allowing the use of powerful metallic cartridges, and were not easily put out of action by adverse weather conditions or harsh use. Furthermore, they could be adapted to take different types of magazine. A fascinating variety of tubular and box magazines soon appeared.



▲ KROPATSCHEK GENDARMERIE CARBINE

Date 1878–79

Origin Hungary

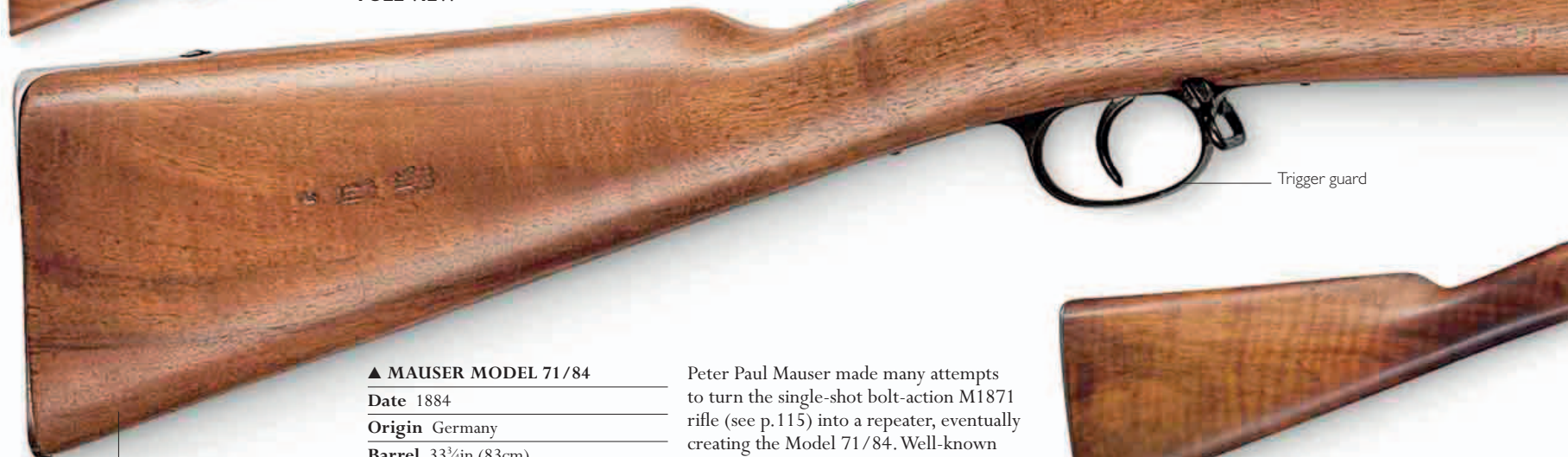
Barrel 29in (73.6cm)

Caliber 11mm

Designed by Alfred Ritter von Kropatschek, a general in the Austrian Army, this rifle was adopted by France and Hungary in 1878. It had a tubular brass magazine built within the forestock for holding six cartridges. Tubular magazines would gradually give way to box magazines, which became more popular.



FULL VIEW



▲ MAUSER MODEL 71/84

Date 1884

Origin Germany

Barrel 33 $\frac{3}{4}$ in (83cm)

Caliber 11 × 60mm rim-fire

Wooden butt

Peter Paul Mauser made many attempts to turn the single-shot bolt-action M1871 rifle (see p.115) into a repeater, eventually creating the Model 71/84. Well-known flaws included weaknesses in the design of its magazine and its tendency to pull to the right. This gun eventually fell out of use in 1888.

